

Chapter 91 - Help

Three days later, Feng Yue and Yan Lin were discharged from the hospital simultaneously. Yan Lin's body had long since recovered—once her high fever broke, she was fine. In contrast, Feng Yue's leg injury could barely manage on its own even after three days.

Yan Lin lived alone in Vancouver. Jiang Shu felt sorry for her and wanted to thank her for saving Feng Yue once again, so she took over all of Yan Lin's daily meals.

At this moment, Yan Lin was sitting at the dining table in Feng Yue's uncle's house, with Feng Yue sitting right beside her.

Today, only Feng Yue's family of three and her grandparents were home, making exactly six people including Yan Lin.

Looking at this familiar scene, Yan Lin couldn't help feeling somewhat sentimental. Before she and Feng Yue divorced, they had also been a family. They had also sat together for meals like this.

"A Lin, how long are you planning to stay in Vancouver this time?" Feng Hehai asked casually.

Yan Lin glanced at Feng Yue, then looked away and replied, "It's not certain yet. I have plenty of time and can stay as long as needed."

Hearing this, the elders looked at Feng Yue, then at Yan Lin, understanding something in their hearts.

Feng Hehai raised his eyebrows. "That's good. You can take this opportunity to rest well. Vancouver has a nice environment."

"Mm."

"In the future, feel free to come play chess with Feng Yue's grandfather when you have time. It's not easy to find someone who can match the old man's skills."

The old master snorted lightly, ignoring his son-in-law's words.

Although Yan Lin found these words somewhat strange, she still nodded.

"It's good that you agreed. Otherwise, when we return to China, the old master won't have anyone to play chess with."

As soon as Feng Hehai said this, Yan Lin instinctively turned to look at Feng Yue. Feng Yue, who had been quietly eating, was also stunned upon hearing this.

Yan Lin: A Yue is returning to China? When did this happen?

Feng Yue: I'm returning to China? How do I not know about this?

The two stared at each other in confusion. Feng Yue turned to look at Feng Hehai. "Dad, we're returning to China?"

"Yes." Feng Hehai nodded. "We've been staying at your uncle's house for so long, and the New Year is over. We should return to China."

Jiang Shu nodded beside him. "We really should go back. If I don't return, Aunt Chen¹ won't have enough people to play cards with."

Feng Yue: "..."

"But didn't I arrange everything before we came? We're supposed to travel around before slowly returning to China." Feng Yue stabbed at the food on her plate with her fork, somewhat dissatisfied.

"With all your injuries, you still want to go out and play? Just honestly return to China to recover." Jiang Shu reached out and took the plate from Feng Yue's hands, then switched it with her own already-cut steak. "Eat properly. How are you still acting like a child?"

Feng Yue angrily forked a piece of steak and stuffed it in her mouth. "My injury isn't serious, and I've arranged everything. You must go with me!"

This was the first time Feng Yue spoke so firmly to her parents. She was afraid that if she didn't take this trip with her family, she might truly never have another chance.

As the only person who knew Feng Yue's secret, Yan Lin couldn't help but feel heartache seeing Feng Yue's frustrated expression.

So she also spoke up to persuade them: "Uncle and Aunt, A Yue has planned this trip for a long time. Please go with her."

Jiang Shu put down her utensils and looked disapprovingly at Feng Yue. "Nuanuan, don't be so willful. Your leg injury hasn't healed at all. If your father and I get carried away playing outside, who will take care of you? Moreover, it takes a hundred days to heal from bone and muscle injuries². Even if your injury looks fine now, if it doesn't heal properly, you'll suffer on rainy days."

Feng Yue argued back: "Mom, I just accidentally sprained my ankle. It's not as serious as you say. Besides, I can take care of myself. You and Dad just need to have fun!"

Thinking this was her last chance, Feng Yue became both anxious and annoyed, and her eyes even began to redden quietly.

"No, your injury—" Jiang Shu still disagreed, but this time her words were interrupted by Yan Lin before she could finish.

Seeing Feng Yue's distressed emotions, Yan Lin took the initiative to say, "Aunt, I can take care of A Yue."

All three family members were stunned, especially Feng Yue, who was in the middle of her emotional outburst and was completely dazed upon hearing this.

But she quickly came to her senses. Yan Lin was the only person who knew why she was so insistent. If her parents really needed someone to take care of her before they would agree to go, then that person could only be Yan Lin.

Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai didn't take Yan Lin's words seriously. After all, the two had divorced, so Feng Yue would definitely refuse.

However, after a long while, they still didn't hear Feng Yue refuse Yan Lin. Only then did the two elders look at their daughter with bewildered expressions.

"Nuanuan... A Lin, she..." Feng Hehai's expression was somewhat indescribable.

But Feng Yue stubbornly kept her neck stiff and said obstinately, "If you insist on having someone take care of me, then let her come along."

Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai: "..."

"Sweetheart, are you serious?"

Feng Yue hummed with her head down.

Feng Hehai opened his mouth, not knowing what to say, but Jiang Shu frowned, very puzzled.

"Nuanuan, why do you insist that we must go together this time? Wouldn't it be better if we returned to China first and waited for your injury to heal before coming out again?"

Cold sweat instantly covered Feng Yue's back. She blinked and said, "I just don't like the feeling of having plans disrupted. I've arranged everything, and Dad has even sorted out his work. We have no reason not to go."

Jiang Shu squinted at Feng Yue. "Is that really the case?"

"Of course, what other reason could there be?"

Jiang Shu thought carefully but really couldn't find any other reason. She sighed and said, "So you're sure about letting A Lin come with us?"

The two looked at each other and nodded emphatically together, "Yes!"

"Alright, then let's go."

Hearing this, Feng Yue finally breathed a sigh of relief.

After dinner, Yan Lin pushed Feng Yue's wheelchair out to the courtyard, where warm sunlight bathed both of them.

With her biggest worry resolved, Feng Yue stretched contentedly, then turned to look at Yan Lin sitting beside her. "Thank you for what you did just now."

Yan Lin shook her head and smiled gently while tidying up the hair around Feng Yue's forehead. "I said I would always protect you, no matter when or where."

Feng Yue turned her head away, avoiding her gaze. The emotions in those eyes were too intense—it was a side of Yan Lin she had never seen before.

"I'll trouble you with what comes next."

"It's no trouble. As long as it's your business, nothing is troublesome." Yan Lin looked at the crown of Feng Yue's head, her heart feeling completely soft.

She could sense that Feng Yue's attitude toward her was different from before. Perhaps it was because they had been completely honest with each other, or perhaps it was because of what she had said in the small cabin.

In any case, Feng Yue's attitude toward her now was more like reconnecting with a long-lost good friend.

Both familiar and strange.

The two just stayed quietly in the courtyard, enjoying the sunlight and the rare peaceful time.

Jiang Shu set their departure date for three days later, right after the Lantern Festival³. Feng Yue had no objections to this arrangement.

What was particularly special this year was that the day before the Lantern Festival was February 14th, International Valentine's Day.

European countries are generally very open-minded. This year, not only did the siblings Jiang Pingrui and Jiang Shu⁴ go out with their respective partners to celebrate Valentine's Day, but even Feng Yue's grandparents went out hand in hand after lunch.

Only four single young people were left at home.

At least Feng Yue and Yan Lin had some ambiguous relationship going on—Jiang Zhao and Jiang Ming were the truly single ones⁵.

These past few days, Yan Lin would generally come over in the morning, then follow behind Feng Yue for the whole day, only leaving after dinner.

During this time, she generally wouldn't leave Feng Yue's side by more than ten meters.

Her meticulous indulgence and pampering of Feng Yue made Jiang Ming's teeth ache from watching.

The four were currently huddled in the media room watching a movie. The movie was somewhat boring, so everyone was looking at their phones.

Jiang Ming suddenly became angry for some reason, angrily tapped her phone a few times, then threw it aside and lay back on the sofa with a lifeless expression.

Feng Yue was somewhat curious. "Cousin, what's wrong?"

Jiang Ming seemed to be waiting for her to ask. She immediately sat up. "You don't know—I asked all my friends, and they're all celebrating Valentine's Day! Fine, I thought the four of us could go out and have fun later, so I sent messages to book places, but everywhere is fully booked, not a single vacancy."

"That's normal. Today is Valentine's Day, it only happens once a year." Jiang Zhao took a sip of his carbonated drink and shrugged.

Jiang Ming slumped her face and sighed toward the sky. "I just don't understand—are there really this many people in Vancouver? These places usually aren't this popular."

"If there's nowhere to play, then let's just stay home. Being at home is pretty good too." Feng Yue patted her shoulder comfortingly.

"Help me! Do I really have to stay home all day on Valentine's Day?! This isn't scientific!"

Jiang Ming was wailing there, Jiang Zhao was making sarcastic comments on the side, and Feng Yue was busy "mediating."

After the three chatted noisily for a while, Yan Lin finally cleared her throat and coughed twice.

"I have a place. Do you want to go?"

The three turned to look at her.

"Mm, an amusement park with hardly anyone there."

Hearing this, Jiang Ming's eyes lit up. On Valentine's Day, all the amusement parks in downtown Vancouver were packed. Who wouldn't be tempted by an amusement park with hardly anyone there!

Besides, having something was better than having nothing!

So the four reached a consensus and quickly drove to the amusement park.

When the four arrived at the amusement park entrance by car, Jiang Ming looked at the completely empty and deserted amusement park in front of her with an indescribable expression.

"Miss Yan, this is the amusement park you mentioned?"

Although you said there were few people, having absolutely no one is too ridiculous!

Yan Lin awkwardly touched her nose. "This children's amusement park is a project of one of my business partner's companies. It's currently in a trial operation phase, so it's not open to the public. However, all the amusement facilities inside are complete and brand new."

Jiang Zhao sighed helplessly. He never imagined that as someone in his twenties, he would one day "rent out" a children's amusement park with a group of other people in their twenties.

"Since we're already here."

Footnotes:

1. Aunt Chen (陈阿姨) - A family friend who plays cards with Jiang Shu
2. "It takes a hundred days to heal from bone and muscle injuries" (伤筋动骨一百天) - A Chinese saying meaning that bone and muscle injuries take a long time to heal properly
3. Lantern Festival (元宵节) - A traditional Chinese festival that marks the end of Chinese New Year celebrations
4. Jiang Pingrui and Jiang Shu - Feng Yue's uncle and mother respectively, mentioned as siblings
5. "Single dogs" (单身狗) - Chinese slang for single people, often used humorously